600091_A25_T12: Honours Stage Project

Interim Report

Date:

Word Count:

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1. Project Overview

An excellent report will present a succinct and detailed summary of the project's aims and objectives. It will set the project context, providing a concise and cogent overview of the issues involved, followed by a statement of the project goals (aims and objectives).

- Aims and objectives
- Feature driven agile

2. Project Technical Progress

An excellent report will show clear evidence of technical progress, in the form of requirements capture and analysis, significant design work, probably including early prototype software or hardware. Technical progress should demonstrate a good understanding of the main technologies and remaining challenges.

2.1 Requirements Capture and Analysis

To correctly identify the scope and ensure consistent and specific project objectives, project requirements must be gathered and refined to create a clear pathway for the project and it's aims. Appendix A contains an example of one requirement used in this project, which includes a priority rating (1 – Highest priority, 5 – Lowest priority), description of the requirement, user inputs, feature or application outputs, any persistent changes made, and any related requirements or use cases to track which user stories are being fulfilled.

2.2 Design

It was important to design the application according to existing project heuristics (Gonzalez-Holland et al., 2017) to improve the user experience and keep the application both easy to use and simple to understand. High fidelity prototypes can simulate some functionality and show user flows and are relatively quick to create rather than a full in-framework mock-up. Figma (*Figma: The Collaborative Interface Design Tool*, n.d.) is a design tool which can be used to create high-fidelity prototypes. Appendix B contains the high-fidelity prototype of the application design. The

Two University-provided Virtual Machine (VM) will be used to host the application through API calls to the database. One VM (STU-706631-VM2.net.dcs.hull.ac.uk) is a development environment to facilitate testing and debugging, the other VM (STU-706631-VM3.net.dcs.hull.ac.uk) will be used to host the final project. Both VMs run on Windows Server 2025 (*Windows Server 2025 | Microsoft Evaluation Center*, n.d.) which is optimised for quick database access. The proposed database platform Firebase (*Firebase | Google's Mobile and Web App Development Platform*, n.d.) contains many resources for both developing and publishing applications such as user authentication and app hosting.

- Design work will be basis of implementation

2.4 Remaining Challenges

- Actually working in these environments
- Firebase and [React]

3. Project Management

An excellent report will show evidence of good project management and implementation of chosen software development or research processes. Evidence of *consistent* progress will be provided. Excellent work will show evidence of appropriate time management, decision making with relation to resources and delivery against plans and goals. Changes to the original project plan will be documented and explained.

3.1 Personas and User Stories

Personas are commonly used to guide feature goals and consider additional characteristics not defined in the requirements. By creating rounded personalities and attributing them to use cases, each requirement can be better conceptualised by the developer.

Formal requirements can be reworked into user stories which promotes a user-focused outlook. User stories follow a set format that takes the user/actor into consideration

- Personas so we can conceptualise the issues we want to fix without app (gap in market/combine multiple good ideas and learn from past)
- User stories to conceptualise the requirements into an easier format to action and assess whether it has been done

3.2 Modified Project Plan

- WE ARE LOCKING IN THIS TERM ON GOD
- Started it, had a breakdown, bon appetite

3.3 Updated Gantt Chart

3.3.1 Original Gantt Chart

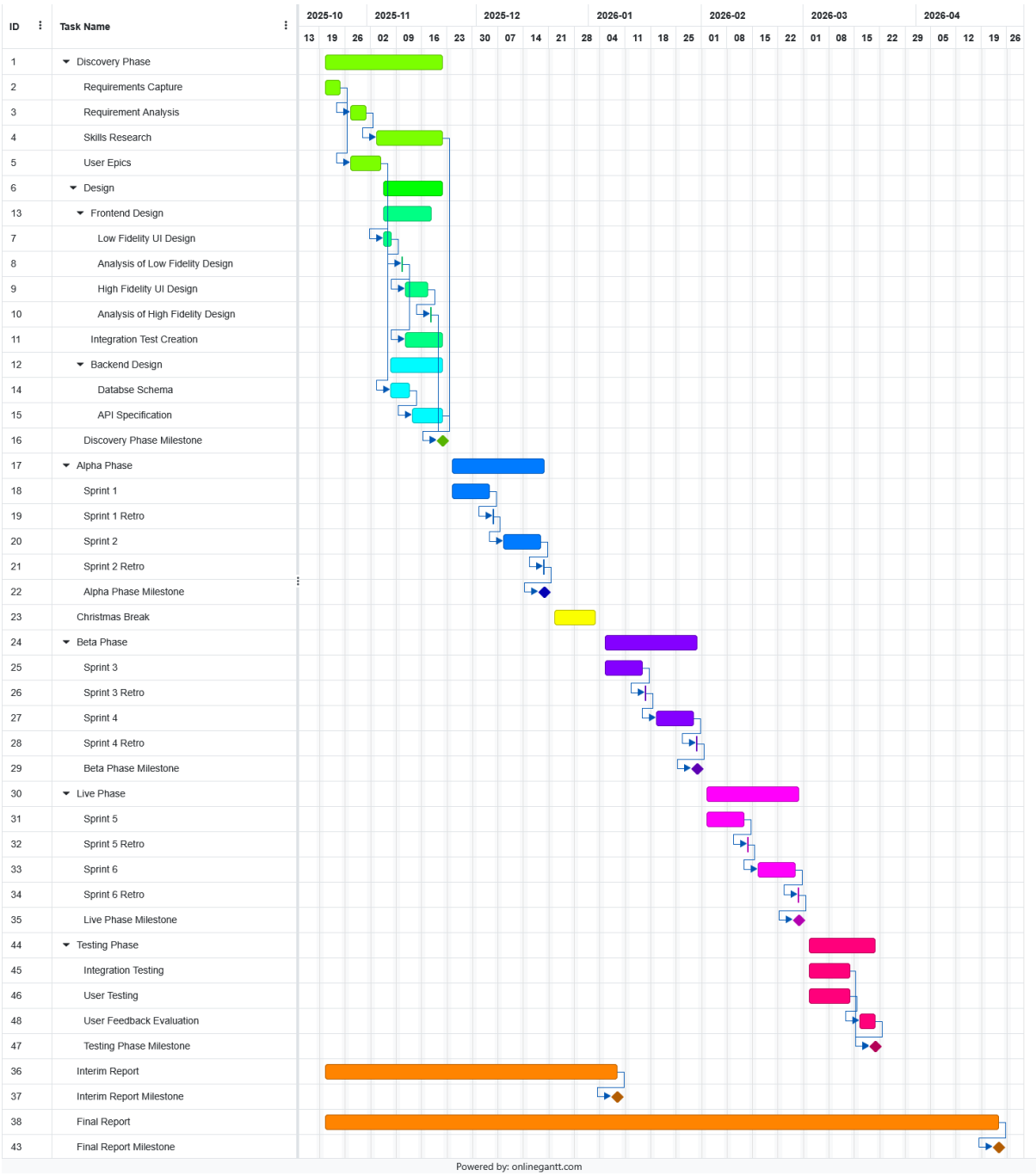


Figure 3.1 - Original Gantt Chart as seen in the PDD

3.4 Management Reflection

4. Appendix

Appendix A

Requirement ID: R1.4

Requirement priority: 1

Requirement Description: The user must be able to delete their account

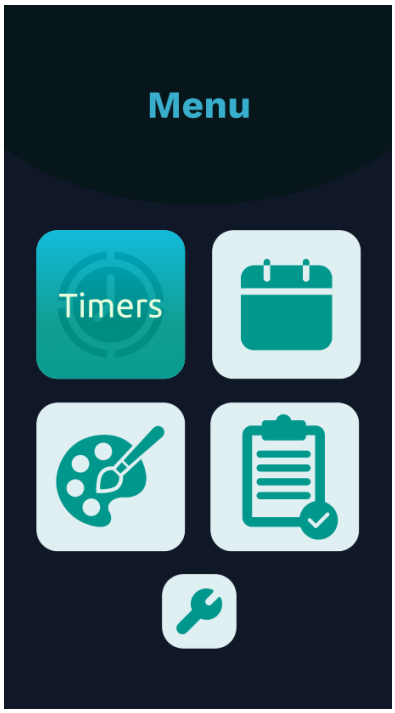
Inputs: user email, user password

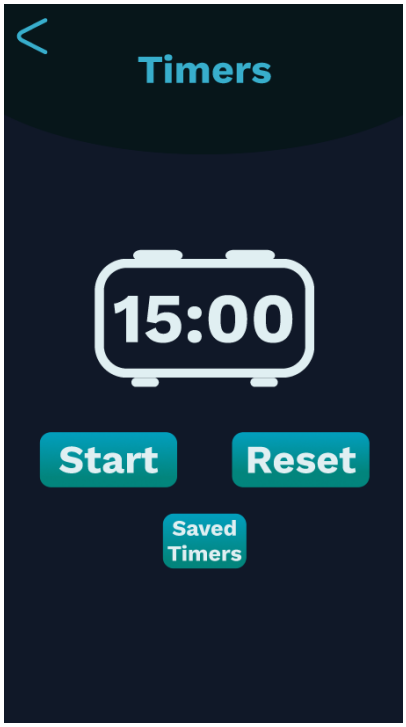
Outputs: error message, confirmation message, confirmation email

Persistent Changes: user account is deleted from the database as well as all information connected to account

Related Requirements and Use Cases: R1.1, R1.2

Appendix B

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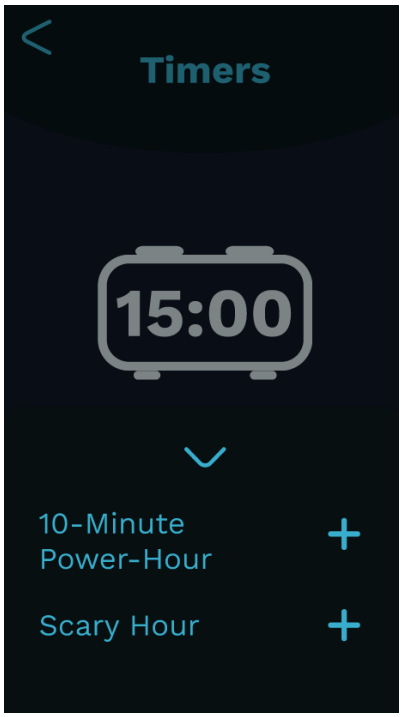
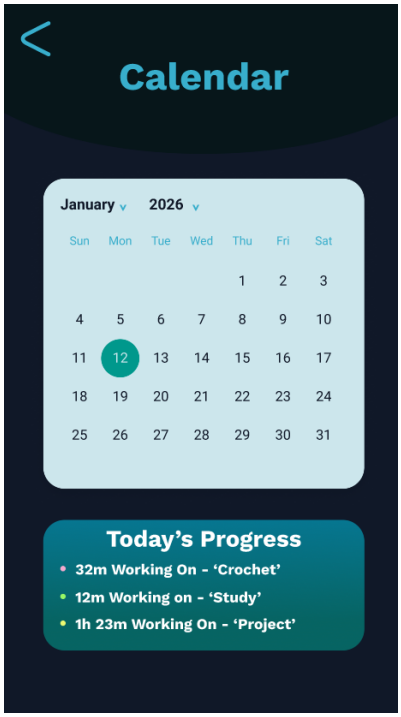
15:00
Start
Reset
Saved Timers


Timers
15:00
10-Minute Power-Hour
Scary Hour


Calendar
January
2026
Sun Mon Tue Wed Thu Fri Sat
1 2 3
4 5 6 7 8 9 10
11 12 13 14 15 16 17
18 19 20 21 22 23 24
25 26 27 28 29 30 31
Today's Progress
32m Working On - 'Crochet'
12m Working on - 'Study'
1h 23m Working On - 'Project'

Appendix C

"I want to do well in my degree so I can follow my passions"

ABOUT

Harriet enjoys learning immensely, and has no struggles with active participation in seminars and lectures. However, once she has to begin her coursework she finds it immensely difficult to keep focused and self-motivate. She is worried her lack of productivity will cause her to hand in work which doesn't reflect her understanding of the topics and sell herself short.

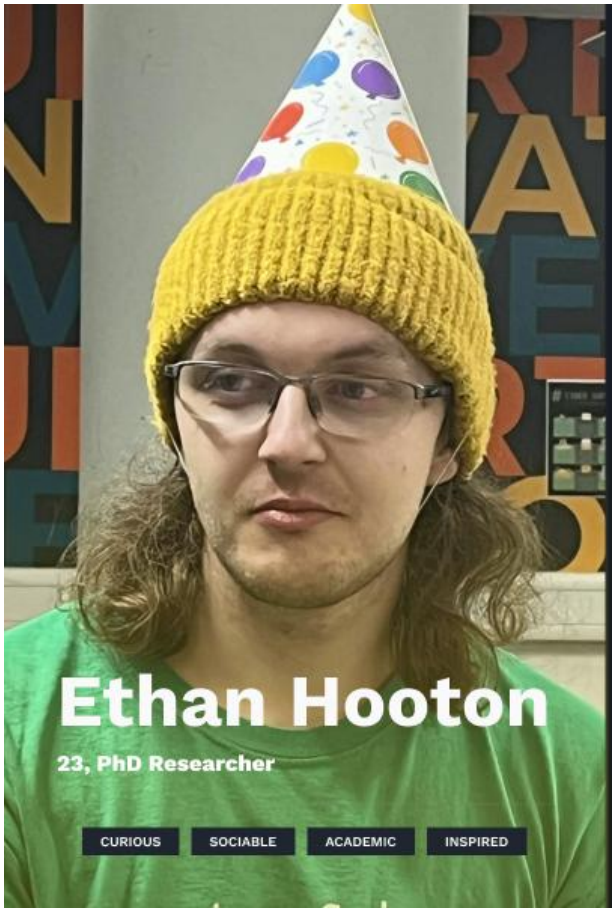
Harriet wants to find a study method which suits her, but doesn't know where to start.

GOALS

- Find and commit to a study routine that works for her
- Find external motivation to foster meaningful study
- Feel rewarded for her efforts and plan her time more effectively

FRUSTRATIONS

- Feeling that her work doesn't reflect her understanding due to working on a time crunch rather than in manageable chunks
- Cannot find a study schedule that works for her
- Struggles to self motivate for work



Ethan Hooton

23, PhD Researcher

CURIOUS | SOCIABLE | ACADEMIC | INSPIRED

"My studies mean everything to me, and want to make studying easier for others

ABOUT

Ethan is a psychology student who is researching focus and productivity. He needs a reliable way of tracking when his subjects are studying and for how long. At the moment he is asking his subjects to record how long they are working on video and send it in weekly, which is causing him a lot of extra work.

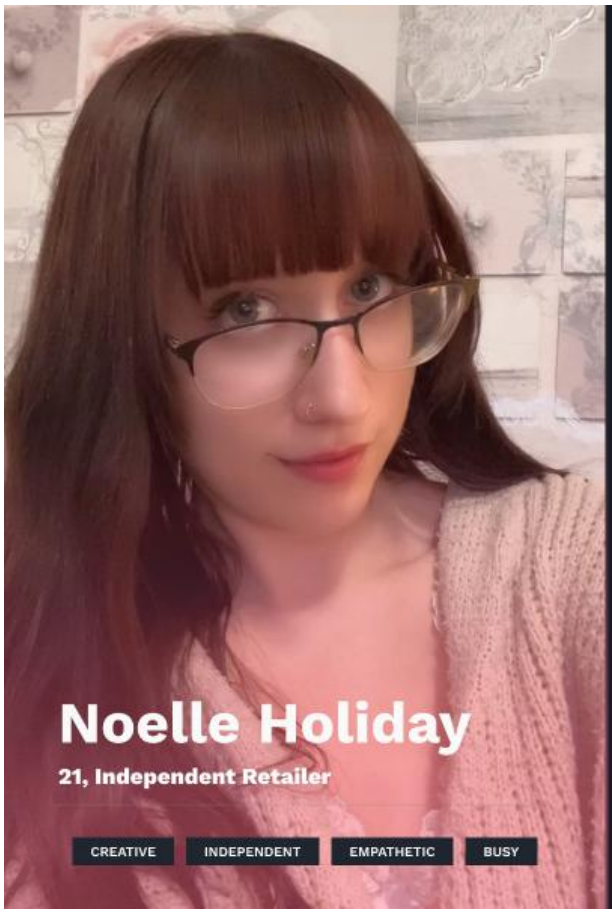
Ethan eventually wants a way of tailoring each of his subject's study sessions to create a control group and study the change in productivity with the different study session lengths.

GOALS

- Easily record and save study sessions
- Allow each subject to have their own account to record their progress
- Edit and save new timers to create focus groups

FRUSTRATIONS

- Currently having to sort through many different formats of saving data
- Doesn't have a way to set and save study sessions
- Doesn't have an easy way to gauge timers usage with individual subjects



Noelle Holiday

21, Independent Retailer

CREATIVE | INDEPENDENT | EMPATHETIC | BUSY

"I want my life to be curated, including the tools I use to keep organised"

ABOUT

Noelle makes and sells crochet online. To make sure she is adequately paid for her time and effort, she has begun timing herself when she works to accurately price her goods. She is also something of a fashionista and enjoys curating her life around her given aesthetic.

Noelle finds it difficult to fit her crochet into her packed schedule and keeps missing deadlines/events as her calendars are hard to keep track of separately.

GOALS

- Keep up-to-date on her projects and upcoming deadlines
- Accurately record her work on multiple projects
- Customise her experience based on her aesthetic

FRUSTRATIONS

- Not many calendar apps allow full customisation, or merging of online calendars
- Cannot find suitable method of storing her working hours consistently
- Storing differing information across multiple applications is confusing and overcomplicated

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